

CHINA SURGICAL ROBOTS

#3: Accelerating Overseas Commercialization Supports Guidance Delivery; Domestic Softness Largely Expected

Chinese surgical robotics companies have continued to attract significant investor attention given their long-term globalization potential, a theme we highlighted when we initiated coverage in April ([thematic report](#), [initiations here](#) and investor [feedback](#)). However, we believe **recent overseas commercialization progress is yet to be fully reflected in the share price**, as investors remain focused on order verification, the sustainability of overseas demand, and the sentiment impact from Intuitive Surgical's recent share price weakness (~30% in the past three months). We remain constructive on the theme and believe continued evidence of overseas commercial traction, procedure growth, and order execution will be key to strengthen investor confidence and support further re-rating; reiterate our **Buy rating on Medbot and EdgeMed**.

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Global commercialization remains on track, with strengthening overseas execution translating into accelerating financial performance.

- **MicroPort MedBot's** July 22 [profit alert](#) marked a key inflection point, with 1H26 profitability achieved alongside c.200–230% yoy revenue growth, driven by strong Toumai adoption and >450% yoy overseas revenue growth. Gross margin expanded by more than 15ppt, supported by scale benefits and product mix improvement. Investor focus is likely to remain on revenue sustainability and accounts receivable collection. Operationally, Toumai has reached c.300 cumulative commercial orders globally, including 240+ overseas orders and 80+ systems installed as of Jun 2026, while Edge Med expects cumulative installed/shipped systems to reach c.160 by 1H26 (c.100 overseas, c.60 domestic), with 60 systems installed/shipped YTD. Utilization continues to ramp, with Edge Med's cumulative procedures exceeding 20,000 as of May 2026 and annual procedures per installed system reaching c.210 in China versus c.100 overseas.
- **India and South America remain key growth markets**, with Toumai reaching 30+ cumulative orders in India and c.20 each in Brazil and Argentina as of Jun 2026, while Edge Med has accumulated c.10 orders in both India and Brazil as of Jun 2026. **Europe is also showing encouraging early traction**, with Toumai securing orders across Italy, Spain, Belgium, the UK and France, including c.10 commercial installations in Spain during 1H26, while Edge Med has achieved 10+

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cumulative orders in Poland and 5+ in Italy. Looking ahead, **expansion into developed markets remains on track**, with Edge Med targeting Japan/Korea approvals by end-2026 to early-2027 and building direct sales capabilities in the UK, Germany and France to support further order growth.

Product differentiation, rather than pricing, remains the key competitive lever.

- While investors remain concerned that intensifying domestic competition could evolve into an EV-style price war and eventually spill over into overseas markets, management teams emphasized that purchasing decisions are driven more by product capabilities, clinical value, and ecosystem development than by upfront pricing alone. MedBot is targeting distinct customer segments through its dual-product strategy, with the premium Toumai Pro priced at c.70% of da Vinci and the cost-effective Toumai SE at a further c.30% discount to Pro. Beyond pricing, remote surgery continues to serve as a differentiated capability, supporting brand building, surgeon training, and overseas network expansion. Edge Medical's MP+SP (multi-port plus single-port) platform also provides a differentiated value proposition versus peers. Both companies continue to invest in product innovation to sustain their competitive positioning, with Edge targeting the launch of its next-generation system next year, benchmarked against da Vinci 5, while MedBot plans to introduce its next-generation Toumai platform by end-2026 or in 2027. We therefore view technology differentiation, product breadth, and continued innovation as more important determinants of long-term market share than price competition alone.

Domestic bidding remained soft but largely in line with expectations, reflecting a weaker hospital capex environment with upcoming VBP a key thing to watch

- Industry bidding volume slowed to c.30 systems in 1H26 (vs. 34 in 1H25, based on various channel checks indicating a range of 26–31 systems, see [Exhibit 1](#)), while procurement ASP declined to RMB13.3mn as domestic players continued to gain share (see [Exhibit 2](#)). Notably, da Vinci secured only c.10 bid wins in 1H26, implying <40% volume share, and installed just six systems in China (see [Exhibit 3](#)), underscoring increasing competition from local players and ongoing pricing pressure. Looking ahead, the rollout of provincial pricing catalogs continues to expand across regions and should help standardize reimbursement and charging practices, supporting broader adoption and higher utilization of robotic surgery over the longer term.
- Meanwhile, the **recent inclusion of laparoscopic surgical robots in the Category B provincial VBP framework could create near-term headline and pricing overhangs** as implementation details evolve (see our [previous note](#)). That said, we continue to believe installation quota allocation, rather than equipment pricing, remains the primary determinant of domestic demand. Lower equipment prices alone are unlikely to drive meaningful volume acceleration while hospital purchases remain constrained by quota availability. As a result, we view overseas markets as the key earnings and growth driver for both MedBot and Edge Medical, with the domestic market providing additional upside optionality should quota expansion

accelerate in the next allocation cycle.

Key highlights by players

Medbot's Toumai reached 300 cumulative orders, 200 cumulative installations

- Toumai's **overseas commercialization continued to broaden**, with cumulative commercial orders reaching c.300 globally, including 240+ from overseas. With 80+ systems installed YTD, management reiterated confidence in delivering its 2026 full-year guidance of 200 installations, Rmb1.1bn revenue and full-year breakeven. **Toumai's global roll out continued to broaden**, with commercial installations now spanning more than 60 countries and regions. Since the beginning of 2026, Toumai has newly entered over ten countries or markets, including Saudi Arabia and South Korea, and has obtained market access in over 40 additional countries. Overseas markets continued to track well, especially in populous emerging markets across Southeast Asia and Latin America; for example, India has grown from its first order last year to 30+ cumulative orders currently, while Brazil and Argentina have each reached nearly 20 cumulative orders. In Europe, Toumai has secured orders across Italy, Spain, Belgium, the UK and France. To support the overseas expansion, the group plans to add approximately 100 employees to its overseas team, bringing total headcount to around 200-300.
- On **differentiation**, remote surgery remains a key feature, supporting brand building and surgeon training network expansion in overseas markets. Toumai also obtained CE Mark in Europe for remote surgery in Jun 2026, further enhancing its global remote surgery network capabilities. **Next-generation** Toumai model may be launched by end-2026 or in 2027, with a new design concept and AI functions, though detailed upgrades have not yet been disclosed.

Edge Medical cumulative installed/shipped systems to reach c.160 by 1H26, with 60 added YTD

- **Management expects global cumulative installed/shipped systems to reach c.160 by 1H26** (overseas c.100, domestic c.60), with strong momentum in Europe, Latin America and South/Southeast Asia, with cumulative orders reaching 10+ systems in Poland, c.10 systems each in India/Brazil, and 5+ systems in Italy. Management attributed the overseas traction to Edge Medical's **differentiated MP+SP (multi-port + single-port) platform**, competitive product performance, and rapid iterations closely aligned with surgeons' clinical needs.
- **Continued overseas registration progress:** In July, Edge Medical received Australian approval for its MP1000 (multi-port), SP1000 (single-port), and MSP2000 (multi-port + single-port) systems across urological, gynecologic, general, and thoracic surgeries. As of Jul 22, Edge Med has entered **68 countries and regions globally**. Looking ahead, the company: 1) expects Japan/Korea approvals by end-2026 to early-2027; 2) is building direct sales teams in the UK/Germany/France, with new orders expected next year; and 3) may use its next-generation system, benchmarking against da Vinci 5, for future US/Canada registration.
- **Procedure volume ramping; utilization upside remains meaningful:** Cumulative

procedures exceeded 20k as of May 2026, including 17k multi-port and 3k single-port procedures, with monthly procedure volume ramping to c.1,500. Overseas cumulative procedures reached c.5k within less than a year since July 2025 installment, supported by c.100 overseas installed/shipped systems, of which c.50-60 are mature installed systems. Current annual procedures per installed system reached c.100 overseas and c.210 in China.

- **Continued technology exploration:** On July 24, Edge Medical announced the completion of its investment in PrimalVerse (see the [announcement here](#)), strengthening its AI capabilities and supporting its expansion from standalone surgical robotic systems toward an embodied-AI surgical robotics platform.

Other Chinese players' go global update

- **AK Medical's Orthopedic surgical robots ramp-up on track:** As of June 2026, AK Medical had secured 11 robotic system bidding, including 6 domestic and 5 overseas systems. Management remains confident in achieving its 2026 full-year target of 20 systems and Rmb40mn revenue from robotics business. Management views 2026 as an inflection point for orthopedic robotics commercialization, supported by AK Medical's established orthopedic implant commercial infrastructure and leading market position. AK Medical has already deployed 80+ robotic systems this year, largely under free-use trials of 3-6 months, and targets c.100 deployments for the full year. Management expects continued system installation/deployment to drive procedure growth, with procedure volumes targeted to increase from 4k in 2025 to 10k-14k in 2026, after reaching c.6k in 1H26.
- On May 25th, **Cornerstone's** Sentire Endoscopic Surgical System received EU CE mark and Singapore Health Sciences Authority (HSA) certification, both covering minimally invasive surgical procedures in General Surgery, Gynecology, Thoracic and Urology. In April 2026, Cornerstone completed the first installation in Singapore at Woodlands Hospital under NHG.
- **Surgerii Robotics (Shurui)**, its single-port surgical robot completed its first commercial deployment in Munich, Germany, in May 2026. As the only single-port surgical robot approved in the EU for pediatric procedures, Shurui also completed the first pediatric laparoscopic robot-assisted procedure in Barcelona in June.
- On July 16, **Tinavi Medical** announced the plan to acquire Shanghai MicroPort Orthopedics, with the consideration to be paid through the issuance of new shares by Tinavi (see the [announcement here](#)). According to the company, the acquisition could support Tinavi by combining its surgical robotics capabilities with MicroPort Orthopedics' implant portfolio and overseas commercial network, potentially creating product synergies and expanding its global reach, scale.

Global peers' update

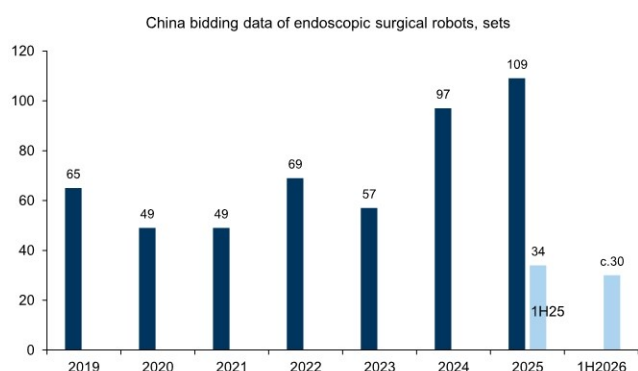
- Read across from **ISRG (Not Covered) 2Q26 earnings:** ISRG's 2Q26 performance in China came under pressure, with only two new system installations (including one da Vinci 5 in Hong Kong, vs. 13 systems in 2Q25). On the earnings call, management noted that China remains challenging, with lower tender activity, intensifying

competition from domestic Chinese brands, and policy-driven pricing pressure, while the impact of charging code changes and the 15th Five-Year Plan quota process remains uncertain. For the capital equipment VBP kicked off recently (see our [previous note](#)), ISRG mgmt noted that it appears to aim at reducing duplication in tendering workflow. Management expects more structured tenders to emphasize comprehensive robotic programs rather than bespoke system-level features and will continue to monitor how the policy is phased in over the coming quarters. Intuitive Surgical share price is down -37% YTD vs the S&P500 +8%.

- **Other update: 1) SSI's** surgical volume exceeding 10,500, and cumulative installations reaching 200+ as of Apr 30th 2026, and the company expects to receive CE mark / FDA approval by 4Q26 / 4Q26-1Q27; 2) **Medicaroid's** Hinotori surgical robot received CE mark on Jul 2026.

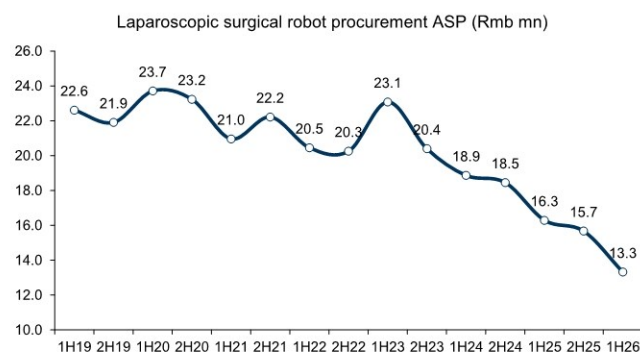
Domestic bidding volume and pricing catalog rollout

Exhibit 1: 1H26 bidding volume slightly below 1H25, due to slower hospital capex spending



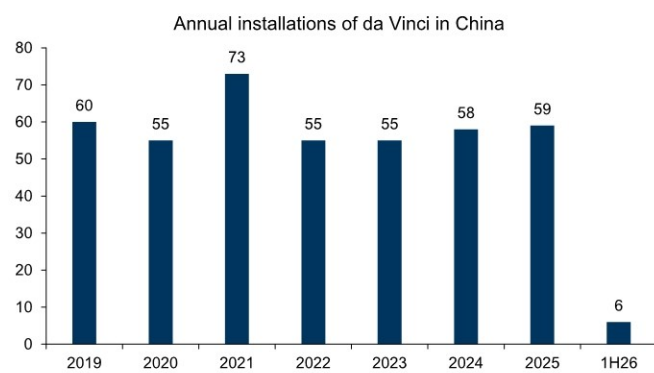
Source: RoboticTech, Joinchain, Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Procurement ASP declined to Rmb13.3mn in 1H26 as domestic brands gained market share



Source: MedRobot, Joinchain, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Only 6 da Vinci systems were newly installed in China in 1H26, reflecting pricing pressure and intensifying competition



Source: RoboticTech, Company data

Exhibit 4: Continued rollout of pricing catalogues across provinces, driving standardization and supporting robotics adoption and utilization uplift

Province	Date	Robotics involvement level			
		<i>Navigation</i>	<i>Participate operation</i>	<i>Accurate operation</i>	<i>Remote Surgery</i>
Hunan	4/7/2026	50% add-on, floor 1.8k; cap 3.6k	150% add-on, floor 5k; cap 12k	300% add-on, floor 16k; cap 26k	500% add-on, floor 20k; cap 37k
Guangdong	4/24/2026	50% add-on, floor 2k; cap 5k	150% add-on, floor 6k; cap 13k	300% add-on, floor 16k; cap 27k	500% add-on, floor 20k; cap 38k
Guizhou	5/15/2026	50% add-on, cap 3.6k	150% add-on, cap 12k	300% add-on, cap 26k	500% add-on, cap 37k
Xinjiang	5/25/2026	no add-on, 1.8k	no add-on, 5k	market-based pricing	market-based pricing
Hubei	5/29/2026	Pricing to be announced			
Guangxi	6/2/2026	50% add-on, floor 1.8k; cap 3.6k	150% add-on, floor 5k; cap 12k	300% add-on, floor 16k; cap 26k	500% add-on, floor 20k; cap 37k
Tianjin	6/2/2026	50% add-on, floor 1.8k; cap 3.6k	150% add-on, floor 5k; cap 12k	300% add-on, floor 16k; cap 26k	500% add-on, floor 20k; cap 37k
Henan	6/12/2026	50% add-on, floor 1.8k; cap 3.6k	150% add-on, floor 5k; cap 12k	300% add-on, floor 15k; cap 25k	500% add-on, floor 20k; cap 37k
Shandong	6/15/2026	50% add-on, floor 1.8k; cap 3.6k	150% add-on, floor 5k; cap 12k	300% add-on, floor 16k; cap 26k	500% add-on, floor 20k; cap 37k
Zhejiang	6/15/2026	fixed price, 2.05k	150% add-on, floor 6k; cap 13k	300% add-on, floor 16k; cap 27k	500% add-on, floor 20k; cap 38k

1. Pricing is in Rmb; 2. The add-on pricing percentage for robotic procedures is based on the standard pricing of the corresponding primary procedure category; 3. Only Category I pricing is shown in the exhibit

Source: Regional Healthcare Security Administrations, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Snapshot of key players

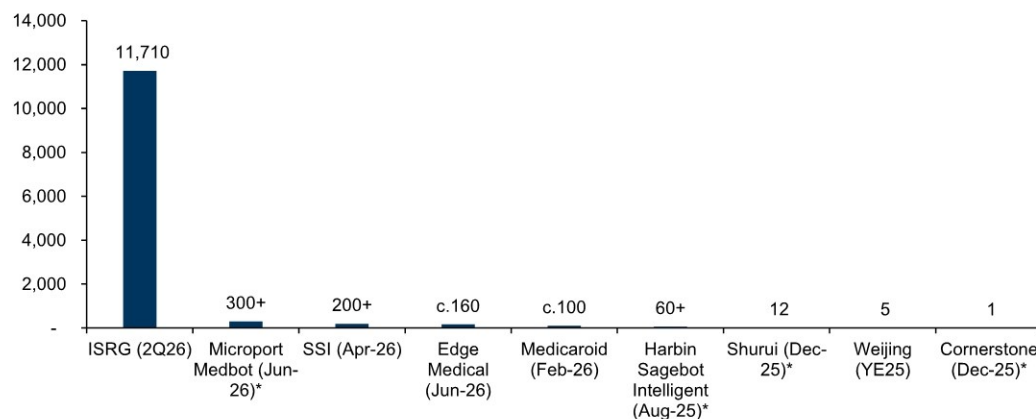
Exhibit 5: Comparison of key players

Company name	Domestic						Overseas				
	MicroPort Medbot 微创机器人	Edge Medical 精锋医疗	Harbin Sagebot Intelligent 思哲睿	Weijing Medical 唯精医疗	Shurui 术锐	Cornerstone 康诺思腾	Intuitive Surgical	Medtronic	CMR Surgical (UK)	SSI (India)	Medicaroid (Japan)
Founded Year	2015	2017	2013	2021	2016	2019	1995	1949	2014	2015	2013
Public/ Private	Public, 2252.HK	Public, 2675.HK	Private	Private	Private	Private	Public, ISRG	Public, MDT	Private	Public, SSII	Private
Product name	Toumai	Edge surgical robot	Kangduo	-	-	Sentire	da Vinci	Hugo RAS	Versius	SSI Mantra	Hinotori
Global registration	60+	68	50+	x	Not disclosed	Not disclosed	72	35+	30+	11	3
Domestic approval	China, Jan 2022	China, Dec 2022	China, Jun 2022	China, Apr 2025	China, Jun 2023	China, Sep 2024	US, Jul 2000	US, Dec 2025	UK, early 2019	India, Jul 2022	Japan, Aug 2020
CE Mark?	✓ May 2024	✓ Jan 2025	✓ Dec 2025	x	✓ Aug 2025	✓ May 2026	✓ Jan 1999	✓ Oct 2021	Early 2019	Expected in 4Q26	✓ Jul 2026
FDA approval?	x	x	x	x	x	x	✓	✓	✓	Expected in 4Q26-1Q27	x
Total installed base	Cumulative 200 installations as of Jun 26, 2026	Cumulative installed/shippment c.160 (c.100 in overseas) as of Jun 2026	Cumulative order 60+ (c.40 in overseas) as of Aug 2025	Cumulative order at low single digit by YE25	Cumulative biddings at 12 per Joinchain (as of Dec 2025)	Cumulative biddings at 1 per Joinchain (as of Dec 2025)	11,710 (US 6615, EU 2,325, Asia 2,111, ROW 659) as of 2Q26	70+ as of YE24	186 as of YE24	200+ as of Apr 2026	c.100 as of Feb 2026
Procedure volume	Cumulative 25k as of Mar 2026	Cumulative 20k as of May 2026	Cumulative c.10k as of Nov 2025	150+ (registration-related usage)	3.5k+ as of Jun 2026	Not disclosed	3.15mn in 2025, c.20mn cumulative as of YE25	Cumulative c.10,000 as of Dec 2025	Cumulative 45k+ as of Mar 2026	Cumulative 10,500+ as of Apr 2026	c.15,000 as of YE2025
Numbers of robotic arms	4	4	3 (SR-1000/2000) 4 (SR-2000)	4	n.a.	4	4	4	5	3 to 5	4
Fluorescence imaging mode types	n.a.	3	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	2	2	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.
Single arm DOF	11	12	12	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	12	7	7	7	7
Single instrument connected to robot DOF	7	7	4	n.a.	7	n.a.	7	7	7	n.a.	n.a.
Image transmission delay	n.a.	40ms	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	<80ms	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.

Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: Da Vinci's installed-base lock-in: Scale far beyond other players

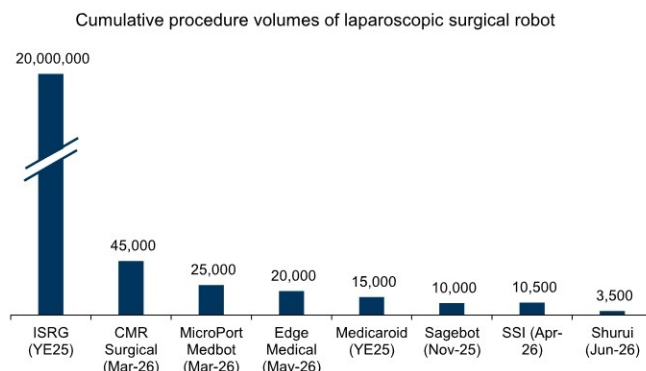
Worldwide installed base of laparoscopic surgical robot



* refers to cumulative orders

Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: Da Vinci's procedure volume lock-in, providing abundant data for analysis and product iteration



Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation and risks

MicroPort MedBot (2252.HK): Our 12-m TP of HK\$40.0 is based on DCF valuation, with 9% WACC and 3% terminal growth (consistent with our medtech & service coverage). Key downside risks: 1) slower-than-expected commercialization and growth in China; 2) potential patent litigation overseas; 3) potential margin pressure from profit-sharing with the MicroPort group and multi-business expansion.

Edge Medical (2675.HK): Our 12-m TP of HK\$74.0 is based on DCF valuation, with 9% WACC and 3% terminal growth (consistent with our medtech & service coverage). Key downside risks: 1) Slower-than-expected commercialization in China, and potential patent litigation overseas; 2) weaker-than-expected capabilities of overseas collaborated distributors; 3) capacity constraints.

Relevant research report

[CHINA SURGICAL ROBOTS: Investor Feedback Post Initiations: Structural Go-global Opportunity Acknowledged; Near-term Focus on Orders, Utilization and Valuation \(May 12th, 2026\)](#)

[CHINA MEDTECH GOING GLOBAL: Assessing the opportunity for surgical robots - global expansion beyond ISRG's core markets \(Apr 21st, 2026\)](#)

[China Healthcare: Surgical Robots: #2: Moderate recovery domestic procurement YTD, increasing globalization efforts from domestic players \(Sep 12th, 2025\)](#)

[GLOBAL HEALTHCARE: Takeaways from Inaugural MedTech & Tools China Trip: Consumer and CapEx Markets at an Inflection \(Mar 11th, 2025\)](#)

[China Healthcare: Updates on procurement of laparoscopic surgical robots; eyes on emerging competition from domestic players \(Jul 22nd, 2024\)](#)

Disclosure Appendix

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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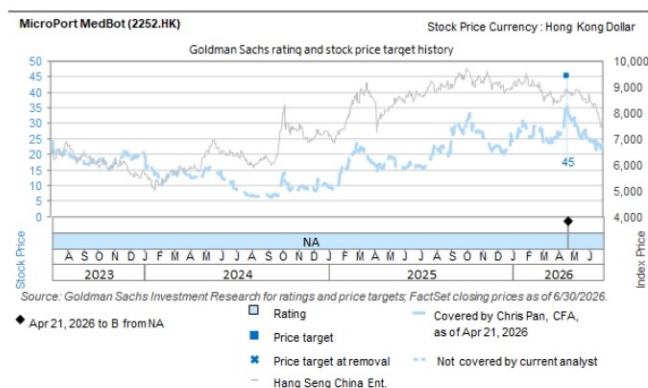
Distribution of ratings/investment banking relationships

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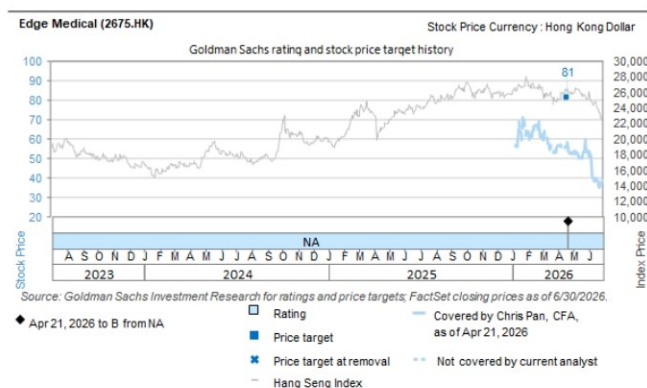
	Rating Distribution			Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell	Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%	65%	59%	43%

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Target price history table(s)

MicroPort MedBot (2252.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
27-Jul-26	40.00	21.48
21-Apr-26	45.00	35.24

Edge Medical (2675.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
27-Jul-26	74.00	40.00
21-Apr-26	81.00	57.85

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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